

Introduction to Machine Learning

Christian Cabrera Jojoa

Senior Research Associate and Affiliated Lecturer

Department of Computer Science and Technology, University of Cambridge

chc79@cam.ac.uk

Course Overview

Welcome to Introduction to Machine Learning! This course will provide you with a comprehensive understanding of machine learning concepts, algorithms, and practical applications.

Course Structure

- 10 sessions of 4 hours each
- Combination of theory and practice
- Hands-on exercises using Python
- Interactive elements (polls, cloud numbers)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this course, you will:

- Understand fundamental ML concepts
- Be able to implement basic ML algorithms
- Know how to evaluate ML models
- Have practical experience with real-world datasets

What is Machine Learning?

Machine Learning is a field of study that gives computers the ability to learn without being explicitly programmed. It's a subset of Artificial Intelligence that focuses on building systems that can learn from and make decisions based on data.

A white rounded rectangular button with a subtle shadow, containing a small icon of a document with a green leaf and the text "ML Overview".

ML Overview

Interactive Example

Here's a simple example of how ML works:

```
from sklearn.datasets import make_blobs
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

---

# Generate sample data
X, y = make_blobs(n_samples=100, centers=2, random_state=42)

---

# Plot the data
plt.scatter(X[:, 0], X[:, 1], c=y)
plt.title("Sample ML Dataset")
plt.show()
```

History of AI and ML

Early Days (1950s-1960s)

- Alan Turing's "Turing Test"
- First neural networks
- Perceptron development

AI Winter (1970s-1980s)

- Limited computing power
- High expectations vs. reality
- Funding cuts

Renaissance (1990s-Present)

- Increased computing power
- Big data availability
- Deep learning revolution

ML Applications

Current Applications

Computer Vision

- Image recognition
- Object detection
- Medical imaging

Natural Language Processing

- Machine translation
- Sentiment analysis
- Chatbots

Recommendation Systems

- Content recommendations
- Product suggestions
- Personalized marketing

Healthcare

- Disease diagnosis
- Drug discovery
- Patient care optimization

Benefits and Risks

Benefits

- Automation of complex tasks
- Improved decision-making
- Personalization
- Efficiency gains

Risks and Challenges

- Data privacy concerns
- Algorithmic bias
- Job displacement
- Ethical considerations

Next Session Preview

In our next session, we will dive deeper into:

- Data preprocessing techniques
- Feature engineering
- Basic ML algorithms
- Model evaluation metrics

Many Thanks!

chc79@cam.ac.uk